

NovaCart

Return Policy

Document Type: Customer & Support Knowledge Base Policy

Version: 1.0

Status: Active for Autonomous Customer Support Copilot Demo

Policy Area	Product returns and return-related customer support
Applies To	Eligible NovaCart orders and products
Return Request Window	Within 7 calendar days of delivery, unless a product-specific policy states otherwise
Supported Region	India
Support Email	support@novacart.example
Support Hours	Monday–Sunday, 9:00 AM–9:00 PM IST

1. Purpose

This Return Policy explains when a NovaCart customer can request a product return, the basic conditions for eligibility, how a return request is submitted, how returned products are reviewed, and what happens after the return is approved.

The policy is designed to provide consistent customer guidance and to serve as an approved knowledge source for the Autonomous Customer Support Copilot.

2. Standard Return Window

Eligible products may generally be requested for return within 7 calendar days from the date of delivery, unless the product listing or a product-specific policy provides a different return period.

The return window is calculated from the recorded delivery date. A customer should submit the return request within the applicable period.

Submitting a request after the applicable window does not automatically qualify the product for return. Exceptions require appropriate review and authorization.

3. Basic Return Eligibility

A product may be eligible for return when:

- The product falls within an eligible product category.
- The request is submitted within the applicable return period.
- The product condition meets the return requirements.
- Required accessories, manuals, tags, or packaging are available where applicable.
- The return reason is supported by the applicable product policy.

Eligibility can vary by product type. The product's specific return conditions take precedence when they are more restrictive or specific than this general policy.

4. Common Valid Return Reasons

Eligible return requests may include:

- Product received damaged.
- Wrong product received.
- Product differs materially from the ordered item.
- Product is defective or not functioning as expected.
- Eligible change-of-mind return where the product category permits it.
- Other reasons explicitly covered by the product's return conditions.

5. Damaged Product

If a customer receives a visibly damaged product, the customer should report the issue as soon as reasonably possible.

The customer may be asked to provide:

- Order number.
- Description of the damage.
- Photographs of the product and packaging.
- Relevant delivery information.

The support team may use the submitted evidence to determine the appropriate next step. The customer should retain the original product and packaging until the return process is completed or support provides further instructions.

6. Wrong or Incorrect Product

If the customer receives a product different from the item ordered, the customer should contact support and provide the order details.

The customer may be asked for photographs showing the received product, packaging, labels, or other identifying information. The item should not be materially altered or used beyond what is reasonably necessary to identify the issue.

After verification, NovaCart may arrange an eligible return and replacement or refund according to the applicable process.

7. Defective or Non-Functional Product

A customer who receives a defective product should describe the issue and provide relevant evidence when requested.

Depending on the product category, support may first provide troubleshooting guidance. If the issue cannot be resolved or the product qualifies for return, NovaCart may arrange the next step under the applicable return process.

Some electronic or technical products may require additional verification before a return is approved.

8. Change-of-Mind Returns

Some products may qualify for a change-of-mind return when the customer simply no longer wants the product. Such returns are subject to product-category restrictions and condition requirements.

A change-of-mind return may be rejected when the product category is excluded, the return period has expired, or the product no longer meets the required condition.

9. Product Condition Requirements

Unless a specific product policy states otherwise, returned products should generally be:

- Unused or in an acceptable condition for the applicable return reason.
- Free from avoidable damage caused after delivery.
- Accompanied by required accessories and components.
- Accompanied by tags, manuals, or packaging where applicable.
- Packed appropriately for safe return transportation.

Missing components or customer-caused damage may affect return eligibility or the final resolution.

10. Non-Returnable or Restricted Items

Certain products may be non-returnable or subject to additional restrictions because of hygiene, safety, personalization, perishability, software licensing, or other operational considerations.

Examples may include:

- Certain personal-care or hygiene products after opening.
- Perishable or consumable goods.
- Personalized or customized products.
- Digital products or licenses after activation.
- Products specifically marked as non-returnable.

The product listing or applicable category policy should be consulted for the definitive restriction.

11. Return Request Process

A typical return process is:

1. Customer opens the order details.
2. Customer selects the eligible return option.
3. Customer selects or describes the return reason.
4. Customer provides required information or evidence.
5. NovaCart reviews the request.
6. If approved, return instructions are provided.
7. Product is handed over through the supported return method.
8. NovaCart or the designated return process receives the product.
9. The product may be inspected when required.
10. The final resolution is communicated to the customer.

12. Return Pickup

Where return pickup is supported, NovaCart may arrange a pickup from the delivery address associated with the order.

Pickup availability can depend on location, product type, delivery partner coverage, and operational conditions. Customers should package the product according to the provided instructions and make it available during the scheduled pickup window.

A failed pickup may require rescheduling or additional support.

13. Self-Ship Returns

For selected products or locations, NovaCart may provide a self-shipping return option. Customers should use only the return instructions supplied by NovaCart.

Customers should retain shipping or courier evidence until the return is confirmed. NovaCart should not promise reimbursement of self-shipping costs unless the applicable policy or support process explicitly allows it.

14. Return Inspection

Returned products may be inspected when necessary to verify the reported issue and eligibility.

Inspection may consider:

- Product identity.
- Physical condition.
- Reported defect or damage.
- Accessories and components.
- Signs of misuse or avoidable damage.
- Whether the returned item matches the order.

A return request is not necessarily equivalent to a completed refund. The final resolution depends on the outcome of the applicable review.

15. Return Approval and Rejection

If a return satisfies the applicable requirements, NovaCart may approve the return and proceed with the relevant replacement or refund process.

A return may be rejected when:

- The request is outside the applicable return window.
- The product is non-returnable.
- The product condition does not meet the requirements.
- The returned item does not match the order.
- Required components are missing where they are necessary for eligibility.
- Evidence or verification does not support the reported issue.

When a return is rejected, support should explain the applicable reason without inventing a reason that is not supported by the policy.

16. Replacement or Refund

Depending on the product, inventory availability, return reason, and applicable policy, an approved return may result in a replacement or refund.

A replacement is subject to product availability. If a replacement is not available or the applicable process calls for a refund, the case should be handled under the Refund Policy.

The AI assistant should not promise a specific replacement or refund until eligibility and the applicable resolution have been confirmed.

17. Return Shipping and Costs

For eligible damaged, defective, or incorrect-product cases, NovaCart may arrange an appropriate return method according to its operational process.

For customer-initiated returns such as eligible change-of-mind requests, return-cost responsibility may depend on the product category and applicable return conditions.

The support system should not promise free return shipping unless the relevant policy or order process confirms that the customer qualifies.

18. Return Ticket and Escalation

A general question such as “How do I return an eligible product?” can normally be answered using the knowledge base without creating a ticket.

A ticket or human escalation may be required when:

- The return request cannot be verified automatically.
- A customer disputes return eligibility.
- A returned product is reported as damaged during transit.
- Inspection results are disputed.
- The wrong product was received and verification is required.
- A return pickup repeatedly fails.
- A return requires access to internal order or logistics records.

19. Information Required for Return Support

Support may request non-sensitive information such as:

- Order number.
- Product name or identifier.
- Return reason.
- Delivery date.
- Description of the issue.
- Photographs or other relevant evidence.
- Pickup or return reference, if already created.

Customers should not provide passwords, OTPs, PINs, or confidential payment credentials.

20. Examples

Example 1 — General return question:

Customer: “How can I return my product?”

Expected handling: Explain the return process and eligibility requirements. No ticket is normally required.

Example 2 — Wrong product:

Customer: "I ordered a black bag but received a blue one."

Expected handling: Classify as an incorrect-product issue, request order details and appropriate evidence, and create/escalate a ticket if verification is required.

Example 3 — Damaged item:

Customer: "My product arrived damaged."

Expected handling: Ask for the order details and relevant photographs, explain the return process, and escalate when inspection or logistics verification is required.

Example 4 — Expired return window:

Customer: "I received the product several weeks ago. Can I return it?"

Expected handling: Explain the standard return window and check whether a product-specific exception applies. Do not promise an exception.

21. Relationship With Other Policies

This Return Policy works together with the Product & Order Policy, Refund Policy, Cancellation Policy, and Customer Support Policy.

The Return Policy determines return eligibility and the return process. The Refund Policy explains how an approved refund is handled. The Cancellation Policy applies when the customer wants to cancel an order before or during fulfillment.

22. Policy Authority

This document is the authoritative general return-policy source for the NovaCart customer-support knowledge base. Product-specific terms may impose additional restrictions or different eligibility periods.

The Autonomous Customer Support Copilot should retrieve the most relevant policy before answering a return question. If the available information is insufficient to determine a customer's specific eligibility, the AI should ask for appropriate non-sensitive information or escalate the case instead of guessing.

This document is fictional and created exclusively for the Autonomous Customer Support Copilot project.